CONTENT SYSTEMS.AI

The 3PL billing leak checklist

7 month-end checks for fees your warehouse earned and never billed. Run it in the week before invoices go out.

What a small leak adds up to

BILLED EACH MONTH	EARNED, NEVER BILLED	LOST EACH YEAR
$250K	3 in 100	$90K

Illustrative example, not a client result: $250K a month × 3 in 100 = $7.5K a month, or $90K a year. Use your own numbers on page 4.

How to use it

STEP 1
Start with your 5 biggest clients. Leaks hide where volume is highest.

STEP 2
For each check, put the 2 sources side by side: what happened on the floor, and what's on the invoice.

STEP 3
Write the dollars found next to each check, then total them on page 4.

Your warehouse did the work. The invoice never saw it.

The 7 checks

Each check shows what to compare, where the data lives, and the red flag that tells you money is slipping.

☐ 01 Storage past the free period

$ FOUND _____

COMPARE
Pallets and units still on hand after each client's free days vs the storage lines on their invoice.

WHERE THE DATA LIVES
Inventory aging report in your WMS, receiving dates, the client's rate card.

RED FLAG
Aging stock keeps growing, but the storage charge is the same every month.

☐ 02 Accessorials and special handling

$ FOUND _____

COMPARE
Extra work logged on the floor (oversize, fragile packing, rush orders, weekend shifts, manual labels) vs accessorial lines billed.

WHERE THE DATA LIVES
WMS task log, shift notes, client emails and chat requests, the rate card.

RED FLAG
"Can you rush this?" emails in the inbox, and no rush fee anywhere on the invoice.

☐ 03 Kitting and project work

$ FOUND _____

COMPARE
Kits and bundles built, assembly, rework and special projects vs project hours and per-kit fees billed.

WHERE THE DATA LIVES
Work orders, labor hours by job, the email where the client asked for it.

RED FLAG
A project tied up a team for 2 days, and the invoice shows a flat fee or nothing.

☐ 04 Receiving problems and missing ASNs

$ FOUND _____

COMPARE
Inbound that arrived without an advance ship notice (ASN), with wrong counts, or as unlabeled mixed pallets vs receiving exception fees billed.

WHERE THE DATA LIVES
Receiving log, ASN records, dock photos, exception notes.

RED FLAG
Your team spent hours sorting a mixed container, and the line says "standard receiving".

☐ 05 Relabels, inserts and prep

$ FOUND _____

COMPARE
Relabeling, stickering, inserts, bagging and marketplace prep vs per-unit prep fees billed.

WHERE THE DATA LIVES
Special instructions on orders, pack station notes, supply usage.

RED FLAG
Label and insert stock runs down fast, with no matching charges on any invoice.

☐ 06 Disputed invoice credits

$ FOUND _____

COMPARE
Credits issued after a dispute vs what the original data shows. Was the dispute valid, and was the corrected amount ever billed?

WHERE THE DATA LIVES
Credit memo list, dispute emails, the original invoice and its backup.

RED FLAG
Credits given to end an argument, without anyone checking the original data.

☐ 07 Monthly minimums

$ FOUND _____

COMPARE
Each client's monthly total vs the minimum in their contract.

WHERE THE DATA LIVES
Signed contracts, billing summary by client.

RED FLAG
A small client sits under the minimum for months and is billed only for actual usage.

Why it leaks

The work happens on the floor, all month, in lots of small moments. Billing happens at month end, in a spreadsheet, from whatever made it into the system.

Nobody connects the 2 line by line. Peak season makes it worse: more volume, more rush requests, more exceptions, and less time to check.

$200,000

Why catching it at month end matters: in October 2026 a clothing brand moved its fulfillment to a new provider after the old 1 sent a $200,000 back invoice.[1] Billing late can cost you the client, not just the fee.

1 Supply Chain Dive, Oct 20 2026, supplychaindive.com/news/bluffworks-targets-lower-fulfillment-costs-after-provider-switch/833337

Your month-end total

Fill this in after the checks. Then multiply by 12. That's the number to bring to your next ops meeting.

CHECK	CLIENTS CHECKED	$ FOUND
01 · Storage past the free period		
02 · Accessorials and special handling		
03 · Kitting and project work		
04 · Receiving problems and missing ASNs		
05 · Relabels, inserts and prep		
06 · Disputed invoice credits		
07 · Monthly minimums		
Total found this month		
× 12 = your yearly leak		

Doing this by hand every month takes days, so most teams stop after the first pass. The leak comes back the month after.

Want to see your real number, without the spreadsheet?

Content Systems.ai helps 3PLs bill for the work they already do. Our Logistics Systems match what happened on the floor to every invoice before it goes out, on the WMS you already run, with a person approving every bill. Try the lost revenue calculator, then get a free quote with your top AI opportunities.

contentsystems.ai/logistics